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SATURDAY, NOVEMBER 8, 2025

Father details struggle with ICE



FITCHBURG, THURSDAY, NOV. 6

Bystander: ‘Look what they’re doing. He’s seizing.’

Police: ‘Back up.’

Bystander: ‘He’s having a seizure. They’re trying to rip the baby out of her hand.’



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Carlos Sebastian Zapata held his 1½-year-old daughter, Alaia, in their Fitchburg home. Zapata said an ICE agent pressed on his neck and caused him to lose consciousness as agents tried to detain his wife, an incident that was caught on video (top).

Bystanders record as agents stop couple with young child in Fitchburg

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, Laura Crimaldi, and John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

FITCHBURG — A Fitchburg man involved in a violent struggle with Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents Thursday said an agent pushed him, hit around his ribs, and pressed on his neck, causing him to become unconscious as he clung to his wife and young daughter. After a video of the incident went viral, the federal government said agents were targeting the man’s wife after she allegedly stabbed a co-worker in the hand and accused the man of faking a medical emergency to help her evade authorities.

Carlos Sebastian Zapata said in an interview with the Globe that he feared being separated from his wife, who was taken into custody Thursday morning by immigration agents.

“I wasn’t letting go of my wife because they wanted to take her away,” Zapata, 24, said in Spanish Friday during a phone interview.

Video footage of the incident shows bystanders growing concerned and shouting for Zapata’s safety as the agents struggled with him and his wife in a car. He appeared to be suffering from a seizure as he held his young child.

ARREST, Page A10

Women leaders spearhead work on menopause care

Little attention paid to common symptoms

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

Linda Moslow was certain she was having a heart attack. Anxious, unable to sleep, and feeling like she was burning up, she called her doctor, who dismissed her concerns. It would take two more years of suffering through mystifying “roller coaster” health issues before her gynecologist prescribed a patch with estrogen to help ease the havoc caused by Moslow’s ebbing hormones. She was going through menopause.

The life-changing experience inspired Moslow to form a support group five years ago for other menopausal women in her New York community. But she didn’t stop there. Working with her husband, Jeff, who chairs Tufts’ board of trustees, Moslow invited six powerful women, including the dean of the university’s school of medicine, to a brainstorming meeting around her kitchen table earlier this year.

There, the Tufts Women’s Health and Menopause Initiative was born. With a \$4 million donation from the Moslows to fuel its launch, the new initiative unites the university’s schools of medicine.

MENOPAUSE, Page A10

Supreme Court adds to SNAP confusion

Blocks for now order calling for full benefits

By Samantha J. Gross and Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF

The US Supreme Court late Friday entered the increasingly confusing — and desperate — circumstances surrounding the country’s primary food aid program when it blocked a federal judge’s order in Rhode Island that the Trump administration provide full monthly food stamp benefits to 42 million low income and disabled people.

The high court’s intervention just before 9:30 p.m. Friday follows a day in which the US Department of Agriculture said it is “working towards” a court order that it pay full benefits for the program through November.

A federal appeals court in Boston had refused to immediately intervene, saying in a ruling Friday that the government could not justify that it needed an “ad-

SHUTDOWN
DAY 39

14
Failed Senate votes

Sept. 19
Date of last House session

594,048
Workers furloughed

35 days
Previous shutdown record
SNAP, Page A6

JAMES D. WATSON 1928-2025

Nobel laureate who co-discovered DNA’s double helix

By Mark Feeney
GLOBE STAFF

James D. Watson, whose role as co-discoverer of the structure of the DNA molecule in 1953 made him one of the key figures in the rise of molecular biology as well as the obvious choice to be first head of the Human Genome Project, died Thursday.

His son Duncan told The New York Times that Dr. Watson, who was 97, died in an East Northport, N.Y., hospice on Long Island after having been treated in a hospital for an infection.

Dr. Watson was one of three recipients of the 1962 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine for discovering that the structure of DNA was a double helix. The others were Francis Crick, his collaborator, and Maurice Wilkins. In making their discovery, Dr. Watson and Crick drew upon the research of Wilkins and his colleague, Rosalind Franklin, who died in 1958. The prize is not given posthumously.

WATSON, Page C9



MARKUS SCHREIBER/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Dr. Watson, seen in 2004, spent 21 years teaching at Harvard, ultimately earning a university professorship.



Inside pitch

Saturday: Rainy, warm. High: 61-66. Low: 41-46.
Sunday: Cloudy, cooler. High: 50-55. Low: 48-53.
Comics and Weather, **D4-5**.

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Cornell University reached an agreement with the Trump administration that will restore hundreds of millions in federal funding to the university. **A2.**

The Serbian parliament approved a new law to tear down an architectural landmark that NATO bombed in 1999, stripping it of cultural protections and clearing the way for President Trump’s family to replace it with a luxury hotel. **A4.**

More than 2,000 current and former Marines and their families gathered in South Boston to celebrate the 250th birthday of the Marines. **B1.**

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